MY CALM-DOWN TOOLKIT

Practical strategies for children and adolescents

Introduction

Strong emotions are a normal part of life. When children feel angry, worried, frustrated, or overwhelmed, they may need help finding a safe and effective way to respond.

1. Pause and breathe

Find a comfortable position. Breathe gently and naturally, without forcing deep breaths. Notice the feeling of your feet touching the floor. If focusing on breathing feels uncomfortable, simply notice your surroundings.

2. Name the feeling

Try saying, “I feel frustrated,” “I feel worried,” or “I feel disappointed.” Naming an emotion can help you understand what is happening.

3. Take a short break

If appropriate, move to a quiet, safe place. Give yourself time to settle before returning to a difficult conversation or task.

4. Move your body

Stretch, walk, dance, or engage in another suitable physical activity to help release tension.

5. Ask for help

You do not have to manage every difficult feeling alone. Speak to a trusted adult, family member, teacher, or appropriate professional.

My personal calm-down plan

When I begin to feel overwhelmed, I can:

1. Notice this feeling: _____

2. Try this strategy: _____

3. Ask this person for support: _____

Remember: You do not have to feel calm all the time. Learning to manage emotions takes practice, patience, and support.

For educational purposes only. Strategies should be adapted to each child's age, preferences, and needs. This guide does not replace individualized professional support.